The Golden Third – research kit

Initiative 28:28 · model version v4.80 · 1 November 2026 · CC BY 4.0 · contact tax.better@archicrowd.de

The proposal

Taxation and social protection shared by a group of states: no euro of income taxed at more than one third (0/11/19/25/33 % in steps tied to basic needs); social contributions abolished, employers pass at least 80 % of the contributions that disappear into wages; a strong safety net (health, long-term care, minimum pension, basic needs) without premiums; a monthly transformation dividend for every adult; compulsory saving 10 % into a personal account locked until retirement; VAT as a label; legacy debt and pension promises in a common fund.

Five reference countries, 2028 (single employee, change per month)

Country	½ × av. wage	1 × av. wage	2 × av. wage	Legacy surcharge
Germany	+586 €	+726 €	+710 €	15.0 %
France	−147 €	+281 €	+469 €	21.0 %
Italy	+306 €	+415 €	+774 €	22.0 %
Spain	+216 €	+320 €	+334 €	18.4 %
Poland	+1,404 zł	+1,398 zł	+1,541 zł	13.7 %

Method and limits

- One open chain of calculations, official statistics (Eurostat, OECD, national offices) and published surveys; every correction numbered in the log (86 so far). Country models checked against OECD Taxing Wages 2026.
- Static: no behavioural responses in labour supply, saving or migration; pass-through, avoidance and take-up as assumptions or bands. A qualitative review of behavioural effects is available.
- Three internal reviews, carried out with a different AI model from the calculation (October 2026), last covering version v4.42: calculation core confirmed, findings documented. Later changes (up to v4.80) not yet reviewed. Independent review is invited.
- Largest undocumented position: the base of company taxation where customers are.

Figures to cite

No.	Item	Value	Unit	Reference	Status
Z01	Transformation dividend per adult (Germany)	**354**	€ per month	2028, purchasing power 2026	adopted
Z02	Transformation dividend per child (Germany)	**283**	€ per month	as Z01, child share 0.8	adopted
Z03	Gain, single, gross wage € 42,000 (Germany)	**611**	€ per month	2028; pass-through 80 %, surcharge 15.0 %, compulsory saving 10 %	adopted
Z04	Gain, couple with one earner and 2 children, € 42,000 (Germany)	**674**	€ per month	as Z03	adopted
Z05	Working-age households better off (Germany)	**85.1**	%	2028; synthetic microsimulation, pass-through 80 %	check
Z06	All households better off (Germany)	**78.6**	%	as Z05	check
Z07	Pensioner households better off (pension rule BS35)	**64.5**	%	2028, Germany	adopted
Z08	Pensioner households, mean change (pension rule BS35)	**−116**	€ per month	2028, Germany	adopted

No.	Item	Value	Unit	Reference	Status
Z09	Contribution to the common fund of 30 states	**5.15**	% of GDP	annual until repaid	adopted
Z10	Legacy surcharge on all taxes (common rate)	**15.4**	%	fund interest 2.45 %	adopted
Z11	Debt ratio of the fund, peak	**147.5**	% of GDP	in 2055	adopted
Z12	Fund fully repaid	**2098**	year		adopted
Z13	Old pension claims above the dividend (Z)	**9.35**	% of GDP	2028, average of states	adopted
Z14	Total burden, taxes and fund (Germany)	**38.68**	% of GDP	2028; today 40.76 % (Eurostat 2024)	adopted
Z15	Total burden including compulsory saving (own account)	**42.78**	% of GDP	2028	adopted
Z16	Cost of the strong net (Germany)	**9.63**	% of GDP	2028	adopted
Z17	Marginal burden at € 60,000: today / new 2028 (Germany)	**48.8 / 40.0**	% per additional euro	single; new without compulsory saving	check
Z18	VAT label burden, factor lowest / highest income class (Germany)	**0.87 / 1.07**	relative to mean	EVS 2023	adopted
Z19	One-off price level effect of the VAT label 2028	**1.2 to 2.1**	%	mechanical 2.47 %	check
Z20	Gain, single employee at the average wage (Germany)	**726**	€ per month	2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting	adopted
Z21	Gain, single employee at the average wage (France)	**281**	€ per month	2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting	adopted
Z22	Gain, single employee at the average wage (Italy)	**415**	€ per month	2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting	adopted
Z23	Gain, single employee at the average wage (Spain)	**320**	€ per month	2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting	adopted
Z24	Gain, single employee at the average wage (Poland)	**1,398**	zł per month	2028; country's own legacy surcharge after netting	adopted
Z25	Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Germany)	**15**	%	converging to the common rate by 2058	adopted
Z26	Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (France)	**21**	%	converging to the common rate by 2058	adopted
Z27	Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Italy)	**22**	%	converging to the common rate by 2058	adopted
Z28	Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Spain)	**18.4**	%	converging to the common rate by 2058	adopted
Z29	Legacy surcharge 2028 after netting (Poland)	**13.7**	%	converging to the common rate by 2058	adopted
Z30	Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Germany)	**30.1 → 26.1**	index 0–100	official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change	check
Z31	Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (France)	**30.4 → 29.0**	index 0–100	official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change	check
Z32	Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Italy)	**31.0 → 26.9**	index 0–100	official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change	check
Z33	Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Spain)	**30.8 → 25.0**	index 0–100	official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change	check

No.	Item	Value	Unit	Reference	Status
Z34	Gini coefficient 2025 → 2028 (Poland)	**24.9 → 18.7**	index 0–100	official 2025 (Eurostat) plus model change	check

Origin of each figure (file and path): figures-to-cite.csv. "adopted": under the decisions of the initiative; "check": cross-check or sensitivity.

Citation

Initiative 28:28 (2026): The Golden Third – research kit and figures to cite, model version v4.80, 1 November 2026. Zenodo. https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23855733. Licence: scripts MIT, texts and results CC BY 4.0.